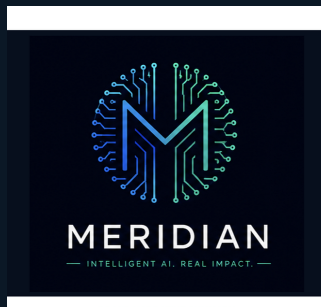




Stargas Supplies

Testing, Supply-Business Opportunities and Grant Aid

Cylinder testing ambition and core gas supply growth, side by side

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PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

THE OPPORTUNITY

Stargas is an independent Irish challenger against two multinational-owned majors, on a rent-free cylinder model with 60+ stockists nationwide. Two separate opportunities sit in front of the business: the cylinder-testing ambition, and growth within the core gas supply business itself. This brief covers both, kept distinct.

PART ONE -- CYLINDER TESTING

Your ambition to build **the best gas cylinder testing location with the best equipment in Ireland** lands on a genuinely thin field — independent research found at most one or two named independent cylinder test houses in the country, one of which markets itself as “Ireland’s only independent cylinder testing facility.” That is a real gap worth testing directly.

- 1. Best-in-Ireland cylinder testing.** The competitive field is thin. The open question worth settling first: where do Irish LPG cylinders currently go for testing, and is that gap real, or already closed off by the majors internally.
- 2. Contract testing for other distributors.** The genuine new revenue line on top of Opportunity 1 — test other companies’ cylinders, not just your own fleet. Turns a compliance cost centre into a second business.
- 3. Grant-funded testing facility upgrade.** Real, named Irish and UK schemes exist and fit a company of Stargas’s profile — see grant aid section below.

PART TWO -- CORE GAS SUPPLY BUSINESS

Five opportunities within the core supply business, kept separate from the testing ambition, ranked by evidence strength and ease of near-term action.

- 1. The online-ordering gap.** Calor and Flogas UK both offer real online self-service — but only for bulk-tank customers. Cylinder customers are still routed to buy in person at a stockist. Neither major has closed this

gap. Stargas already has a basic buy-online/collect feature — a real head start to build a proper cylinder-focused ordering and reminder service on.

2. **Off-grid rural and agricultural heating.** Only ~700,000 of Ireland's ~2 million homes are on the gas grid — a large, structural base already core to Stargas. The opportunity is sharper, named marketing (grain-drying season, calving-season calf-shed heating) matching what Calor and Flogas already do deliberately, not a new capability.
3. **Industrial and welding gases.** A natural adjacent line using the filling depot, fleet and stockist network Stargas already has — the lowest-effort item on this list.
4. **Campervan and leisure LPG.** A genuinely growing, evidenced segment — roughly 20,000 campervans and 30,000 caravans in use in Ireland, growth accelerating post-pandemic — and one neither major specifically targets in marketing. A clean opening via campsite/caravan-park stockist partnerships.
5. **Autogas (LPG as vehicle fuel).** Real but the least settled — 1,400+ refuelling sites already exist and Calor markets conversions, but no confirmed Irish government incentive was found. Worth confirming with Revenue/SEAI before building a pitch around it.

GRANT AID INTELLIGENCE

LEO Business Expansion Grant -- the near-term route

For established businesses (Stargas, trading since 2010, qualifies easily) that are micro-enterprises. Funds new equipment purchase at up to 50% of investment, capped at €80,000 (up to €150,000 in some cases). The single most directly relevant scheme for cylinder-testing equipment specifically.

Enterprise Ireland -- Capital Investment for Decarbonisation

Up to €1m for carbon-reducing capital equipment. A credible next-stage route if the testing facility investment is framed around energy-efficient compressors, heat recovery, or BioLPG-handling infrastructure.

SEAI EXEED Grant Scheme

Up to €3m per project for decarbonisation/energy-efficiency capital investment — the larger-scale option if the testing facility is bundled with wider site energy upgrades.

Invest NI Business Innovation Grant -- if NI expansion is pursued

£5,000–£20,000 at 70% support for market research and market entry — a natural fit for a first NI feasibility study, on either the testing or supply side.

Recommended path: LEO Business Expansion Grant first, as the concrete near-term route; EI/SEAI as the credible next stage if any investment scales up. All figures independently sourced; none invented.

Overall Read

Both ambitions are genuinely live, not stretch goals. On testing: the competitive field is thin, the regulatory anchor (EN 1440, TPED) is clear, and real grant support exists to fund it — the one fact worth settling first is where Irish cylinders currently go for testing today. On core supply: the sharpest near-term win is closing the online-ordering gap neither major has closed, while off-grid heating remains the largest base already in hand.